

flavors, and this makes me the idiot of the day. Excuse me while I go back up my work.

OK, I'm back.

Now let's talk about intelligent risks. When I invest \$100,000 in an Internet company, I'm engaging in an intelligent risk. When I sold my Internet company, I reinvested part of the proceeds back into the company. I still own a minor percentage and it is completely passive. Why did I invest \$100,000 and expose myself to the risk? I assessed the acquiring company's probability of success to be high. Their goal was to take my small company and transform it into a \$100 million company. If they succeed, my small \$100,000 investment would then be worth \$2 million. The downside? The company could fail and the liquidation value of my investment would lose about 50%. My downside is limited while the upside is substantial. This is an intelligent risk.

If you quit your job to engage in a Fastlane business, it's an intelligent risk. Your upside could be millions. The downside? You might have to live below your standards: mop floors, flip burgers, eat rice and beans, and ride your bike to the grocery store. Is that really that bad? Not if you know your destination and your commitment to the roadmap. Again, it all comes down to what you are willing to do and not willing to do. Risk involves careful stewardship of choice. Minimize moronic risk and take advantage of intelligent risk. As for failure, trust me—it is *easier to live in regret of failure than in regret of never trying*.

### **SMACK "SOMEDAY . . ."**

What prevents people from hitting the Redline?

*Someday* does. Someday I will . . . someday I'll do this, someday I'll do that, someday when the kids are grown, someday when the debts are paid . . . someday. And yet, someday never comes. Someday is a distant horizon in the theater of your mind.

Someday is dangerous and paralyzing. It traps you in land of Nowheresville. Someday is here, now, pristine and clean and begging no allegiance for tomorrow. The Fastlane petitions you for this simple transformation: *Make someday today*.

Ever drive somewhere and all the traffic lights are green? Unfortunately, when it comes to opportunity and risk minimization, people wait for perfect timing—they wait for all lights to go green, which summons the "somedays." Ask anyone seeking Slowlane escape . . . why haven't you made the leap? What are you waiting for? It's always some excuse . . .

"I'm waiting for a promotion."

"I'm waiting for my kids to be older."

"I'm waiting to be debt-free."

"I'm waiting until I inherit money."